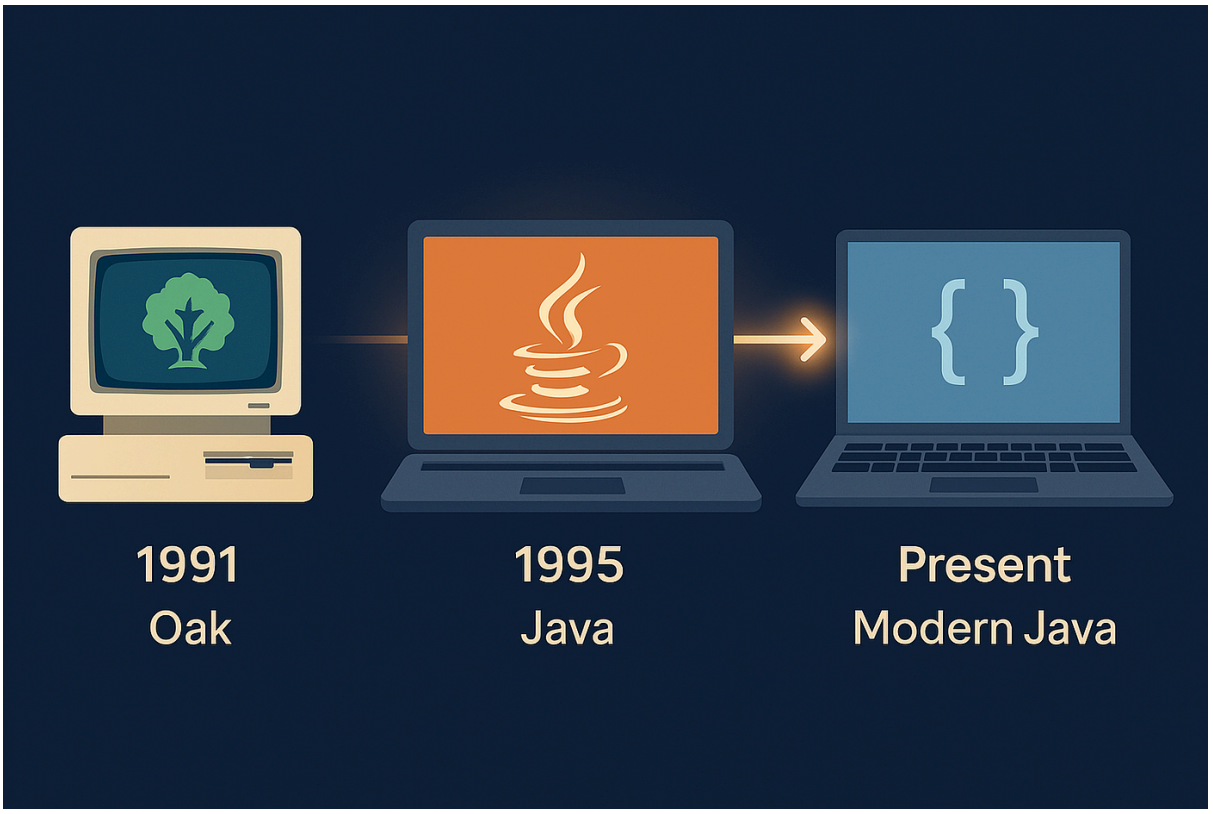
☕ History of Java (Complete, Interview-Ready Notes)

Sun
microsystems


1991
Oak
1995
Java
Present
Modern Java

🧠 Origin of Java

Java was developed by **James Gosling** and his team at **Sun Microsystems** in **1991**.

Originally, Java was created for **consumer electronic devices** like TVs and set-top boxes.

📅 Timeline of Java History

🔹 1991 — The Beginning (Project Oak)

- Java project started as **"Oak"**
- Designed for **embedded systems**
- Named after an oak tree outside James Gosling's office 🌳

🔹 1995 — Java Officially Released

- Name changed from **Oak** to **Java**
- Released to the public
- Became popular for **internet programming**

Key slogan:

> **Write Once, Run Anywhere (WORA)**

🔹 2009 — Oracle Acquires Sun Microsystems

- **Oracle Corporation** purchased Sun Microsystems
- Java development continued under Oracle

🔹 2014 — Java 8 (Major Version)

Important features added:

- Lambda Expressions
- Stream API
- Functional programming support

Java 8 is still widely used in industry.

🔹 2023–Present — Modern Java

Latest versions include:

- Better performance
- Improved security
- Cloud and microservices support

🧾 Why Java Was Created

Problems with earlier languages:

- Platform dependent
- Complex memory management
- Security issues

Solution:
Java introduced:

- Platform independence
- Object-oriented design
- Automatic memory management

🌍 Real-World Impact of Java

Java is used in:

- Banking systems
- Android applications
- Enterprise software
- Web applications
- Big data systems

Examples:

- ATM systems
- Online banking
- E-commerce platforms

🎤 Most Asked Interview Questions

1. Who invented Java?

James Gosling

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2. When was Java developed?

1991

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3. What was the original name of Java?

Oak

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4. Why was the name changed from Oak to Java?

Because **Oak** was already trademarked by another company.

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5. Who owns Java now?

Oracle Corporation

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6. What is Java’s slogan?

Write Once, Run Anywhere

🧠 Short Exam / Interview Answer (2–3 lines)

Java was developed by James Gosling at Sun Microsystems in 1991. It was initially called Oak and later renamed Java in 1995. Java became popular because it is platform-independent and follows the principle of Write Once, Run Anywhere.